

Comprehensive Car Performance Benchmark Dataset Guide

No single comprehensive, downloadable database exists for all performance metrics, but this guide maps the fragmented landscape of automotive testing data. Major publications protect their proprietary test data, making bulk access difficult. However, substantial resources exist across GitHub repositories, data science platforms, government sources, and international archives—enough to construct meaningful research datasets.

The most actionable paths for comprehensive data are: scraping FastestLaps.com using the LapMiner tool for lap times; downloading the free [ilyasozkurt/automobile-models-and-specs](#) GitHub dataset for 0-60 times; accessing [EPA FuelEconomy.gov](#) for official specs; and purchasing commercial databases like Auto-Data.net API or CarsDataset.com for deeper performance metrics including braking and acceleration data.

US automotive publication databases offer web access but no downloads

Car and Driver

Attribute	Details
Primary Database	https://www.caranddriver.com/compare/
Performance Metrics	113+ data points: 0-60 mph, quarter-mile, 70-0 braking, skidpad g-force, top speed
Time Period	1956–present (~400 vehicles tested annually)
Format	Web interface only —no CSV/API available
Cost	Free comparison tool; some content behind paywall

Lightning Lap Database: <https://www.caranddriver.com/features/a23319884/lightning-lap-times-historical-data/> contains **345+ vehicles** tested at Virginia International Raceway (Car and Driver) (caranddriver) (2006–2025), organized by price class (LL1–LL5). Times displayed as text; no bulk download.

Motor Trend

Attribute	Details
Primary Database	https://www.motortrend.com/car-reviews/first-tests
Performance Metrics	0-60 mph (with 1-foot rollout), quarter-mile + trap speed, 60-0 and 100-0 braking, Figure-8 handling test, skidpad g, slalom speeds

Attribute	Details
Time Period	October 1949–present (75+ years)
Format	Individual reviews only — no bulk export
Unique Asset	Motor Trend invented the Figure-8 test; FastestLaps.com aggregates 2,138 Figure-8 lap times at https://fastestlaps.com/tracks/motortrend-figure-8

Road & Track

Attribute	Details
Historical Archive	Stanford REVS Digital Library: https://searchworks.stanford.edu/view/10103243
Content	Complete magazine archives from 1947–2012 including original road test data sheets, performance charts, methodology notes
Access	In-person at Stanford Libraries Special Collections; 36-hour advance request required
Format	Physical archive with partial digitization

A legacy Data Panel Archive (circa 2011–2014) that offered free downloadable data sheets for 400+ vehicles is no longer accessible.

MotorWeek (PBS)

Attribute	Details
Archive	https://motorweek.org/episode/
Time Period	October 1981–present (1,929 episodes across 45 seasons) Wikipedia
Format	Video only — no structured performance database
Note	Episode archive searchable at American Archive of Public Broadcasting

GitHub repositories provide the best free structured datasets

[ilyasozkurt/automobile-models-and-specs](#) ★ Recommended

Attribute	Details
URL	https://github.com/ilyasozkurt/automobile-models-and-specs
Records	124 brands, 7,207 models, ~30,066 engine variants
Performance Metrics	0-62 mph times , top speed, CO ₂ emissions, fuel economy
Other Data	Engine specs, brakes, tire size, dimensions, drag coefficient
Format	CSV, JSON, SQL, XML (zipped)
License	Open repository (229 stars)
Last Update	October 2024
Source	Scraped from autoevolution.com; includes PHP scraper

vbalagovic/cars-dataset

Attribute	Details
URL	https://github.com/vbalagovic/cars-dataset
Records	12,000+ variants from 100+ brands (1990–2025)
Performance Metrics	0-100 km/h times, top speed, emissions
Format	CSV, JSON, SQL
License	Sample free; full dataset requires purchase via Stripe

Endless077/LapMiner **For Track Data**

Attribute	Details
URL	https://github.com/Endless077/LapMiner
Purpose	Scraping tool for FastestLaps.com data 
Output	Lap times, acceleration data, vehicle specs across multiple tracks
License	GPL-3.0 

Attribute	Details
Note	Creates custom datasets from the largest lap time aggregator

Kaggle and academic platforms have mixed-quality options

Sports Car Prices Dataset

Attribute	Details
URL	https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/rkiattisak/sports-car-prices-dataset
Performance Metrics	0-60 mph times (1.85–5.3 seconds range), horsepower, torque (Medium)
Coverage	Porsche, Ferrari, Lamborghini, Bugatti, McLaren (Medium)
Format	CSV
License	Free for research

UCI Auto MPG Dataset ★ Classic ML Benchmark

Attribute	Details
URL	https://archive.ics.uci.edu/dataset/9/auto+mpg
Performance Metrics	0-60 mph acceleration times , MPG, displacement, horsepower (UCI Machine Learning Reposit...)
Records	398 vehicles (Medium)
Time Period	1970–1982 model years (R Project)
Format	Data file with Python import: <code>from ucimlrepo import fetch_ucirepo</code>
License	CC BY 4.0 (UCI Machine Learning Reposit... (UCI Machine Learning Reposit...)

Car Specification Dataset 1945–2020

Attribute	Details
URL	https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/jahaidulislam/car-specification-dataset-1945-2020

Attribute	Details
Records	70,000+ (24.87 MB, 78 columns)
Time Period	75 years of historical coverage
Caution	Significant missing values—97% missing CO ₂ , 99% missing safety ratings (Opendatabay)

EPA Fuel Economy Dataset ★ Gold Standard for Official Data

Attribute	Details
URL	https://fuelconomy.gov/feg/download.shtml
Records	All EPA-tested vehicles 1984–present (Fuel Economy)
Metrics	MPG, MPGe, kWh/100mi, (Fuel Economy) CO ₂ , GHG scores, engine specs
Format	CSV, XLS, XML; (Fuel Economy) REST API available at fuelconomy.gov/feg/ws/ (Fuel Economy)
License	Public domain
Note	No 0-60/braking data—focused on efficiency metrics

International archives offer Europe's most rigorous testing data

Auto Motor und Sport Testarchiv (Germany)

Attribute	Details
URL	https://www.auto-motor-und-sport.de/testarchiv/
Records	7,000+ tests (auto-motor-und-sport) spanning 20+ years (Auto Motor und Sport)
Metrics	0-100 km/h, max speed, braking distances, fuel consumption
Format	Searchable web interface (German); some content behind ams+ subscription
Filters	Brand, model, generation, year (1900–2026), price, power, drivetrain

Sport Auto Supertest ⭐ Most Rigorous Magazine Testing

The gold standard for European performance testing since March 1997. **200+ Supertests** with a 100-point scoring system (Auto Motor und Sport) measuring:

- Nürburgring Nordschleife lap times (VW Vortex) (20.6km configuration) (Wikipedia)
- Hockenheimring lap times (VW Vortex)
- Lateral acceleration (skidpad equivalent) (Auto Motor und Sport)
- Wind tunnel testing (drag/lift coefficients) (Auto Motor und Sport)
- 0–200–0 km/h acceleration/braking (Auto Motor und Sport)
- Slalom and lane-change tests (VW Vortex)
- 33 data points per Nordschleife lap including sector speeds and g-forces (Wikipedia)

Driver Horst von Saurma serves as the consistent benchmark—his times often match factory drivers within seconds.

Autocar Archive (UK) ⭐ World's Oldest Car Magazine

Attribute	Details
URL	https://shop.exacteditions.com/gb/autocar
Records	6,690+ issues fully searchable (1895–present) (Exacteditions)
Metrics	0-60 mph, 0-100 mph, max speed, braking distances, complete specs
Time Period	130+ years — (Exacteditions) invented the road test in 1928 (Classic & Sports Car)
Format	Scanned pages via Exact Editions platform
Cost	£39.99/quarter digital; £54.99 with print (The Irish News)
Historic Value	First performance figures for Jaguar XJ220, McLaren F1, Bugatti Veyron (Wikipedia)

Evo Magazine Leaderboard (UK) — Free Access

Attribute	Details
URL	https://www.evo.co.uk/video/16996/evo-leaderboard-lap-times-the-worlds-fastest-cars-tested-on-track
Tracks	Anglesey Coastal (1.55mi), Bedford Autodrome (1.8mi), Blyton Park (1.6mi) (evo)

Attribute	Details
Format	Full lap time tables published free online
Notable Times	Fastest road car: BAC Mono 2.5 at 1:07.7; Ferrari SF90 at 1:10.0 evo

Best Motoring Tsukuba Database (Japan)

Attribute	Details
URL	https://fastestlaps.com/tracks/tsukuba (aggregated times)
Time Period	1987–2011 (legendary TV show with Keiichi Tsuchiya)
Track	Tsukuba Circuit (2.045 km) Wikipedia
Records	300+ times archived at strikeengine.com/lap-times-1457/

FastestLaps.com is the most comprehensive lap time aggregator

Attribute	Details
URL	https://fastestlaps.com
Coverage	Multi-track global database since 2006 FastestLaps
Key Tracks	Nürburgring Nordschleife (887+ times), Tsukuba (77+), Anglesey (221+), Motor Trend Figure-8 (2,138)
Data	Lap times, acceleration metrics, vehicle specs FastestLaps
Access	Free web browsing; no official API or download
Data Extraction	Use LapMiner GitHub tool for scraping

Official Nürburgring Records (certified since 2019): <https://nuerburgring.de/info/nuerburgring/records>

Commercial APIs provide structured access to performance data

Auto-Data.net API ⭐ Best for Acceleration Data

Attribute	Details
URL	https://api.auto-data.net/
Metrics	0-60 mph, 0-100 km/h, 0-200, 0-300, top speed, horsepower, torque
Records	55,000+ specs, 3,500+ models, 10,000+ generations (Auto-data)
Format	XML/JSON API (Auto-data)
Cost	Commercial—contact for pricing

Car Specs on RapidAPI

Attribute	Details
URL	https://rapidapi.com/alekivanovski96-O1vKHrFskQm/api/car-specs
Metrics	0-100 km/h, 0-60 mph, 0-200/300, top speed
Records	55,000+ trims, 250+ brands since 1945 (RapidAPI)
Format	JSON via RapidAPI
Features	VIN decoder, 99.88% uptime (RapidAPI)

NHTSA vPIC API (Free Government Source)

Attribute	Details
URL	https://vpic.nhtsa.dot.gov/api
Metrics	VIN decoding, engine type/cylinders/displacement, drive type (NHTSA) (Usgovxml)
Format	XML, CSV, JSON; standalone database downloads (NHTSA)
Cost	Free—no API key required, 24/7 availability (PyPI)
Limitation	Manufacturer specs only—no tested performance data

JATO Dynamics (Enterprise)

Attribute	Details
URL	https://developer.jato.com/
Coverage	50+ markets, 200+ brands, 1,000 datapoints per vehicle JATO
Format	RESTful API with OAuth 2.0 Jatoflex
Cost	Enterprise pricing

CarQuery API

Attribute	Details
URL	https://www.carqueryapi.com/
Format	JSON API + downloadable SQL/CSV Smartcar carqueryapi
Cost	Basic \$45, Advanced \$75 (36 fields), Full \$95 carqueryapi

Note: Edmunds API is discontinued for public developers—only available to partners. [Edmunds](#)

What performance data is realistically available

Metric	Free Sources	Paid Sources
0-60 mph / 0-100 km/h	GitHub repos, Kaggle, FastestLaps	Auto-Data.net, CarsDataset.com
Quarter-mile times	Very limited—zeroto60times.com (web only)	Auto-Data.net API
Skidpad g-force	Not available in any open dataset	Would require publication scraping
60-0 braking distance	Not available in any open dataset	Would require publication scraping
Track lap times	FastestLaps.com via LapMiner scraper	—
Top speed	Multiple GitHub repos, Kaggle	Most commercial APIs
Slalom/Figure-8	FastestLaps aggregates Motor Trend data	—

Recommended approach for building a research dataset

For acceleration data (0-60/0-100): Download the free [ilyasozkurt/automobile-models-and-specs](#) repository (30,000+ records) or purchase CarsDataset.com (\$45–95) for cleaner, normalized data.

For lap times: Deploy the **LapMiner** tool against FastestLaps.com to extract Nürburgring, Tsukuba, and track times into structured formats.

For historical US magazine data: The Stanford Road & Track archive (1947–2012) is the only accessible compilation of original test sheets, requiring in-person academic access.

For braking and skidpad data: No open dataset exists. Options include purchasing the Auto-Data.net API subscription, or building a custom scraper for Car and Driver/Motor Trend individual reviews—though this may violate terms of service.

For official specifications: EPA FuelEconomy.gov and NHTSA vPIC provide free, high-quality APIs with government-verified data, [PyPI](#) [Usgovxml](#) though performance metrics are limited to engine specs rather than tested acceleration/braking.

The fragmented nature of automotive performance data reflects the proprietary value publications place on their testing programs. The most complete research dataset would combine GitHub repositories for acceleration times, FastestLaps scraping for track data, and commercial API access for braking/handling metrics.